

Formatting handover

Original research · 4,800 words · 41 references · 47 changes, all tracked

This is a redacted sample. It shows the structure and level of detail of a real deliverable. Client names, journal names and identifying particulars have been removed or changed. Ask us and we will send one built around a manuscript like yours.

What was changed, and why

Every change is listed against the line of the journal’s instructions that required it, so a co-author who disagrees can see the reason rather than argue with the file.

Area	Change	Instruction
Structure	Section order set to the template; “Materials and Methods” renamed “Methods”.	IFA §2.1
Abstract	Restructured to four headed sections; cut 288 → 246 words.	IFA §2.3
Keywords	Six supplied, drawn from the journal’s controlled list.	IFA §2.4
Word count	4,800 → 3,460, within the 3,500 limit. References excluded, as this journal excludes them.	IFA §2.2
References	Converted to Vancouver, numbered by first citation.	IFA §5.1
Figures	Captions moved below; callouts added at first mention.	IFA §4.2
Declarations	Ethics, consent, registration, funding, conflicts, data availability and AI use placed as required.	IFA §6

Reference audit

Run before the style was applied, because restyling a broken list produces a tidy broken list.

Finding	Count	Resolution
In-text citations with no list entry	6	Traced and added.
DOIs that do not resolve	3	Two corrected; one replaced with the published version.
Duplicate entries	2	Merged and renumbered throughout.
Preprints now published	1	Updated to the journal version.
Total after merges	41	Within the journal’s cap of 40 after two merges were agreed with you.

Figures

Figure	Issue	What was done
F1	Required as a CONSORT flow diagram; none supplied.	Built from the participant numbers in the text.
F2	96 dpi screen capture — would have failed at upload.	Rebuilt from source data at 600 dpi line art.
F3	RGB, caption above, no callout.	Converted to CMYK TIFF at 300 dpi; caption moved, callout added.
T1–T3	Footnote symbols and units inconsistent.	Symbols set to the journal's sequence; units made consistent.

One item is left open, deliberately. The CRediT author contribution statement. Only the authors can assign those roles, so we supply the template and leave it to you rather than guessing.

Files delivered

- Manuscript in DOCX with tracked changes, plus a clean copy
- PDF for circulation to co-authors
- Three figure files, named to the journal's convention
- CONSORT 2010 checklist completed with page numbers
- Two supplementary appendices formatted for the portal
- This compliance note

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